

PENNISETUM

P. compressum. See *P. alopecuroides*.

P. longistylum. See *P. villosum*.

P. orientale. Densely tufted, mound-forming, herbaceous, perennial grass. H 2ft (60cm), S 30in (75cm). Has long, upright or arching, dark green leaves. In mid- and late summer, bears long, softly bristled, pink flower heads, resembling bottle brushes. Z5–8

P. rueppellii. See *P. setaceum*.

P. setaceum, syn. *P. rueppellii* (Fountain grass). Tuft-forming, herbaceous, perennial grass. H 3ft (1m), S 1½ft (45cm). Has very rough, mid-green leaves and stems. In summer, bears dense, cylindrical panicles of copper-red spikelets, with decorative, bearded bristles, that last well into winter. Z9–11. **‘Rubrum’** see *P. × advena* ‘Rubrum’. ***P. villosum***, syn. *P. longistylum* (Feather-top), illus. p.286.

PENSTEMON

PLANTAGINACEAE

Genus of perennials and subshrubs, most of which are semievergreen or evergreen. Fully to frost hardy. Prefers full sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate species by seed in fall or spring, or in midsummer by softwood or semiripe cuttings of non-flowering shoots; cultivars only by cuttings. See also feature panel pp.236–237.

P. ‘Alice Hindley’ (illus. p.236). Large-leaved, semievergreen perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Mid-green leaves are linear to lance-shaped. Bears tubular to bell-shaped, pale lilac-blue flowers, white inside, tinged mauve-pink outside, from midsummer to early or mid-fall. Z6–10 ***P. ‘Andenken an Friedrich Hahn’***, syn. *P. ‘Garnet’* (illus. p.237). Vigorous, semievergreen, bushy perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has narrow, fresh green leaves. Bears sprays of tubular, deep wine-red flowers from midsummer to fall. Z5–9

P. ‘Apple Blossom’ (illus. p.236). Semievergreen, bushy perennial. H and S 18–24in (45–60cm). Bears sprays of small, tubular, pale pink flowers from midsummer onward above narrow, fresh green foliage. Z9–11

P. ‘Barbara Barker’. See *P. ‘Beech Park’*. ***P. barbatus***, syn. *Chelone barbata* (illus. p.237). Semievergreen, rosette-forming perennial. H 6ft (1.8m), S 12–20in (30–50cm). From midsummer to early fall, bears racemes of slightly nodding, tubular, 2-lipped, rose-red flowers. Flower stems rise from rosettes of oblong to ovate, mid-green leaves. Z4–8

P. ‘Beech Park’, syn. *P. ‘Barbara Barker’* (illus. p.236). Semievergreen perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 10in (25cm). Leaves are linear and light green. Bears bright pink and white flowers. Z6–10

P. ‘Blackbird’. Vigorous, semievergreen perennial. H 32in (80cm), S 20in (50cm). Has willowy, purplish-red stems clothed in long, lance-shaped, dark green leaves. Bears racemes of deep red-purple flowers, the throats densely streaked deep red, from late summer to fall. Z6–10

P. ‘Burford Seedling’. See *P. ‘Burgundy’*. ***P. ‘Burford White’***. See *P. ‘White Bedder’*.

P. ‘Burgundy’, syn. *P. ‘Burford Seedling’* (illus. p.237). Robust, semievergreen perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 1½ft (45cm).

Leaves are linear and light green. Produces purplish-red flowers with white throats streaked dark red. Z6–10

P. campanulatus, syn. *P. pulchellus*.

Semievergreen, upright perennial.

H 1–2ft (30–60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Long racemes of bell-shaped, dark purple, violet or, occasionally, white flowers are borne in early summer above lance-shaped, toothed, mid-green leaves. Z7–10

P. ‘Candy Pink’. See *P. ‘Old Candy Pink’*.

P. cardwellii. Spreading, sometimes stem-rooting, evergreen subshrub.

H 4–8in (10–20cm), S 1ft (30cm). Mid-green leaves are elliptic and finely toothed. Bears racemelike panicles of slender, tubular to funnel-shaped, deep purple flowers in early summer. (borderline) Z7–10

P. ‘Cherry’ (illus. p.237). Semievergreen perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 2ft (60cm). Has lance-shaped, mid-green leaves. From midsummer to fall, produces an abundance of deep rose-red flowers, with a golden sheen and white throats, streaked deep red. Z9–11

P. ‘Chester Scarlet’ (illus. p.237).

Semievergreen perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Large, bright red flowers are borne above narrowly lance-shaped, light green leaves. Z9–11

P. confertus. Semievergreen, neat, clump-forming perennial. H 1½ft (45cm), S 1ft (30cm). Produces spikes of tubular, creamy-yellow flowers above long, lance-shaped, mid-green leaves in early summer. Z7–10

P. ‘Connie’s Pink’. Erect, much-branched, semievergreen perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 2ft (60cm). Pale green leaves are ovate to lance-shaped. Bears slender, bright rose-pink flowers, with deep pink petal lobes and red-penciled, white throats, from early summer to fall. Z6–9

P. ‘Countess of Dalkeith’, syn. *P. ‘Purple and White’*.

Erect, semievergreen perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Leaves are linear and light green. In summer and fall, produces large, reddish-purple, white-throated flowers. Z3–7

P. davidsonii. Evergreen, prostrate subshrub. H 8in (20cm), S 16in (40cm).

In late spring and early summer, funnel-shaped, violet to ruby-red flowers, with protruding lips, develop from leaf axils. Leaves are small, ovate to rounded, and leathery. Trim after flowering. Z4–8.

var. *menziesii* ‘Microphyllus’,

H to 3in (7cm), S 10in (25cm), is dense and mat-forming, and bears violet-blue flowers. Good planted at a trough edge.

P. diffusus. See *P. serrulatus*.

P. digitalis ‘Husker Red’ (illus. p.236).

Vigorous, semievergreen or deciduous, basal-rosetted perennial. H 20–30in (50–75cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has stems often marked reddish-purple and inversely lance-shaped, unlobed, sparsely toothed, mid-green leaves that are maroon-red when young. Produces panicles of tubular to bell-shaped, pink-tinted, white flowers, with purple lines inside, in summer. Z3–8

P. ‘Ellenbank Amethyst’. Bushy, semievergreen perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has lance-shaped, mid-green leaves. In summer, bears racemes of large, tubular, soft purple, white-throated flowers, each edged vivid rosy-purple. Z5–8

P. ‘Evelyn’ illus. p.233.

P. ‘Firebird’. See *P. ‘Schoenholzeri’*.

P. ‘Flamingo’ (illus. p.236). Open, much-branched, semievergreen perennial. H 3ft (95cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has mid-green, ovate to lance-shaped leaves. From summer to fall, bears white-throated, deep purplish-pink flowers, the white diffusing to petal lobes, with a few darker, reddish-pink pencilings on lower lobes. Z6–10

P. fruticosus. Evergreen, upright subshrub. H and S to 16in (40cm). Has lance-shaped to ovate, toothed leaves. In early summer, produces funnel-shaped, lipped, lavender-blue flowers. Suitable for a rock garden. Trim back after flowering. Z6–10. **var. *scouleri*** (syn. *P. scouleri*) bears pale to deep purple flowers.

var. *scouleri ‘Albus’* (illus. p.236)

produces white flowers.

P. ‘Garnet’. See *P. ‘Andenken an Friedrich Hahn’*.

P. ‘Geoff Hamilton’. Vigorous, semievergreen perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has lance-shaped to ovate, mid-green leaves. Produces large, open, purple flowers, with white throats and white-flecked lobes, from early summer to fall. Z7–10

P. ‘George Home’. Narrow-leaved perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Produces small, tubular to bell-shaped, wine-red flowers, with white throats, the white extending over the lips, from midsummer to early or mid-fall. Z9–11

P. glaber (illus. p.237). Evergreen, variable subshrub. H 20–26in (50–65cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has mid-green, lance-shaped to inversely ovate leaves. In late summer, produces clusters of snapdragonlike, sky-blue to indigo flowers, with maroon pencilings in the white or pale blue throats. Needs a sunny, dry site. (borderline) Z3–10

P. hartwegii. Semievergreen, erect perennial. H 2ft (60cm) or more, S 1ft (30cm). Lance-shaped leaves are mid-green. Bears sprays of slightly pendent, tubular to bell-shaped, scarlet flowers from mid- to late summer. Z8–10. **‘Albus’** bears slender, creamy-white flowers. **‘Picotee Red’** has red, white-throated flowers.

P. heterophyllus (Foothill penstemon). Evergreen subshrub. H and S 12–20in (30–50cm). In summer, produces racemes of tubular to funnel-shaped, pinkish-blue flowers, with blue or lilac lobes. Leaves are linear to lance-shaped, unlobed, and mid-green or bluish-green. (borderline) Z6–10. **‘Heavenly Blue’** (illus. p.237), H and S to 16in (40cm), produces tubular, mauve-tinged, blue flowers from midsummer until the first frosts. **‘True Blue’** has pale green leaves and pure blue flowers, borne on short side shoots. Trim back after flowering. Suitable for a rock garden.

P. ‘Hidcote Pink’ (illus. p.236). Narrow-leaved perennial. H 24–30in (60–75cm), S 1–2ft (30–60cm). Produces small, tubular, pale pink flowers, with spreading lobes marked with crimson lines inside, from midsummer to early or mid-fall. Z9–11

P. hirsutus. Short-lived, evergreen, open subshrub. H 16–32in (40–80cm), S 1–2ft (30–60cm). Leaves are ovate and dark green. In summer, produces hairy, tubular, lipped, purple- or blue-flushed, white flowers. Suitable for a rock garden. Z4–8. **var. *pygmaeus*** illus. p.361.

P. ‘Hopley’s Variegated’ (illus. p.237).

Large-leaved, semievergreen perennial; a sport of *P. ‘Alice Hindley’*. H 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has creamy-yellow-edged, mid-green leaves. Bears tubular-bell-shaped, lilac-blue, white-throated flowers from midsummer to mid-fall. Z8–10

P. isophyllus illus. p.153.

P. KILIMANJARO ‘Yajaro’. Vigorous, semievergreen perennial. H 32in (80cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has long, lance-shaped, mid-green leaves. From summer to fall, bears long racemes of purplish-pink flowers, with white throats. Z3–9

P. ‘King George V’ (illus. p.237).

Narrow-leaved perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Bears small, tubular to bell-shaped, bright, deep scarlet flowers, with white throats, from midsummer to early or mid-fall. Z9–11

P. kunthii (illus. p.236). Variable, woody-based, willowy perennial. H 3–4ft (90cm–120cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has lance-shaped, toothed, mid-green leaves. From midsummer to late fall, produces many-flowered racemes of red to maroon-red flowers, with white streaks in the throats. Requires a sunny, dry site. Z7–9

P. ‘Madame Golding’. Strong-growing, semievergreen perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 16–18in (40–45cm). Similar to *P. ‘Old Candy Pink’*, but has paler pink flowers. Z8–11

P. ‘Margery Fish’ (illus. p.236). Almost mat-forming, woody-based perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has narrow, shiny, mid-green leaves. Produces dense spikes of pale blue to violet-mauve flowers, with white penciling in the throats, from summer to fall. Z9–11

P. ‘Maurice Gibbs’. Semievergreen perennial. H 2½ft (75cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has lance-shaped, light green leaves. Bears claret-red flowers, with white throats, from midsummer to early or mid-fall. Z9–11

P. ‘Modesty’. Strong-growing, erect, semievergreen perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has lance-shaped, glossy, olive-green leaves. Produces bright red-pink flowers, with white throats sparsely penciled purplish-red, in summer and fall. Z7–10

P. ‘Mother of Pearl’ (illus. p.236). Narrow-leaved perennial. H to 2½ft (75cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Bears small, tubular to bell-shaped, pearl-mauve flowers, tinted pink and white, with white throats and red lines, from midsummer to early or mid-fall. Z9–11

P. newberryi. Evergreen, mat-forming shrub. H 10in (25cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has small, ovate, leathery, dark green leaves. Bears short sprays of tubular, lipped, deep rose-pink flowers in early summer. Trim back after flowering. Good for a rock garden. Z6–9. **f. *humilior*** illus. p.340.

P. ‘Old Candy Pink’, syn. *P. ‘Candy Pink’*. Strong-growing, semievergreen perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 16–18in (40–45cm). Has lance-shaped, mid-green leaves. Produces bright crimson flowers, with darker crimson lines in the white throats and small, rounded, white patches at the bases of each lobe, from early summer to mid-fall. Z8–10

P. ‘Osprey’ (illus. p.236). Vigorous, open-branched, semievergreen perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 20in (50cm). Has lance-shaped to